

Getting Started with Quick Reads and the Reading Agency's Six Book Challenge

Topic Introducing Quick Reads to begin the Six Book Challenge.

Level: E3

Time: 90 minutes

Aims

- To develop learners' ability and motivation to read
- To expand learners' vocabulary of book types
- To develop reading for pleasure and interest
- To introduce learners to Quick Read books and the Six Book Challenge

Learning Objectives

At the end of the session learners will be able

- To read and obtain information from a text about the Six Book Challenge
- To use vocabulary for different genre of books
- To speak to communicate information about their own reading preferences

Introduction

This lesson is about developing learners' reading ability by introducing and developing skills through the Six Book Challenge. It provides learners with support to explore and enjoy a Quick Read book. Quick Reads are books written by bestselling authors or well known personalities. Most prison libraries will stock a range of Quick Read books and also have information and materials to support the Six Book Challenge.

Preparing for the lesson

When you are working in prison you are not likely to have access to the internet on site. However, the Reading Agency website at readingagency.org.uk has an impressive amount of materials and information to support the challenge that you may be able to access from elsewhere. Diaries and registration forms can be ordered from the website if they are not already in your prison library.

There is also much information on ways of supporting the challenge with learners including information about the 300+ titles available, Quick Reads books and ideas for teachers and learners to keep going.

For this session you will need:

- A selection of Quick Reads from your prison library
- Six Book Challenge diaries for every learner
- Six Book Challenge registration forms for every learner
- Resources 1, 2 and 4 for every learner.
- Resource 3 per pair of learners, cut up and preferably on card
- Highlighter pens
- Dictionaries per learner or pair of learners



Procedure

Warmer (5 minutes)

- Elicit from learners what they have read recently. They may not be aware of text around them. Have a look around the classroom. What can they see to read? What can they read on their wing? Some examples:
 - notices
 - prison services leaflets
 - health leaflets
 - magazines
 - newspapers.
- Elicit views about reading. What do learners enjoy reading? Has anyone has read a book recently? Has anyone used the prison library?
- Explain today's lesson objectives in 'learner speak' e.g. 'This lesson will help with your reading skills', '*You will find out more about different types of reading*' and '*You will choose a book to read*'.

Task 1 – Speaking and listening: finding out about learners' reading (15 minutes)

Differentiation

- Group the stronger and weaker learners together and give out **resource 1a** (weaker learners) or **1b** (stronger learners) as appropriate.
- Learners should ask their immediate neighbour what they have read and note their name in the second column if they answer yes. Encourage learners to extend the conversation by asking further questions e.g. '*What did you read today?*'
- Tell the more able learners to ask extra questions to find out more about what their partners like reading e.g. '*What type of magazine is your favourite?*'
- Learners should then talk to other learners in the group and note their names (and what they have read for stronger learners).
- If you have enough room and good group dynamics, ask learners to move around the room around the room speaking to as many other learners as possible. Alternatively learners could remain seated and speak to their neighbours. Assess your own prison setting and learners.

Task 2 – Introduction to the Six Book Challenge (15 minutes)

- Distribute **resource 2** and highlighter pens.
- Read the text from Resource 2 aloud asking learners to follow or nominate learners who you know are confident readers.

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- Read the resource again and instruct learners to highlight words they don't understand with highlighter pens. Elicit the meanings of any unfamiliar words.
- Distribute **resource 3** and put learners in pairs.
- Explain that learners should put cards face down on the desk and in turn to pick a card and read it. They should then answer the question verbally to their partner.
- Pairs can help each other and check their responses from Resource 2.
- Elicit answers from each pair to feedback.

Task 3 – Types of books (15 minutes)

- Write the following six genres on the whiteboard: romance; sci fi; biography; crime; adventure and humour.
- Elicit the meanings of the words and/ or some examples from learners. Make sure they understand that they can be different types (genre) of books.
- Distribute **resource 4a** and a dictionary per learner or pair.
- Use dictionaries to look up each genre and match it to the definition.
- Using questions, drill the vocabulary above: ask learners 'What would you like to read?' and they should all give an answer e.g. 'I'd like to read a crime story'
- Distribute Resource 4b and ask learners to look at the book covers.
- Focus on title and author. Use question and answer to drill title and author from the book illustrations.
- Elicit the types of book from the genres on Resource 4a.
- Ask pairs to match the type of book to the description by linking with a line.

Task 4 – Matching the book covers to the descriptions (10 minutes)

- Distribute **resource 4c** and ask individuals, to read the book descriptions and use the text clues to match the introduction to the book cover.
- They should then work with a partner and write the title of the book and author on 4c.
- Feedback to check answers using the board and nominating learners.

Task 5 – Exploring Quick Read books (10 – 15 minutes)

- Hand out a selection of Quick Read books and ask readers to have a look at them in turn during the next few minutes.
- Direct learners to the short summary often found on the back cover or beginning of a book, that gives a brief picture of what the book's about. It can help you choose a



book you would like. Ask them to select one they might like to read (it is fine if a few choose the same book.)

- Ask questions to elicit: *'What made you choose that book?' 'What attracted you to it?' 'Was it the picture on the front, the summary, the size and thickness of the book, the size of print, clarity of print?'* also note if the learners skimmed and scanned some pages and liked what they had read? Had learners heard of the author or the title?

Task 5 - Completing the Six Book Challenge diary (10 minutes)

- Give out the Six Book Challenge diaries and registration forms and complete either in class or for homework. You may want to keep the registration forms or your prison library may be already using the scheme and keep the records.
- Ask learners to have a look at their diary and see if they can find what you get if you complete the Six Book Challenge (a certificate).
- Explore and clarify the 'star' rating. What is the highest number and lowest number of stars you can give a book?
- Look at the last page and discuss how you could find ideas for finding good books to read. This may include: asking friends, library assistants or the librarian; setting up a Six Book Challenge board in the classroom and contributing reviews and reading others' reviews.
- Recap on other texts learners can read for the challenge

Cooler (5 – 10 minutes)

Learners to work in pairs and explain to their partner why they chose their quick read book

Extension activities / Homework

- Arrange a visit to the library with your learners. Find out how you can visit the library from your learners' wing. When do you need to sign up, what do you have to do?
- Make a classroom board for the challenge, have a book review section, a recommended section.
- See if your prison magazine would like an article about the Six Book Challenge that your learners could prepare.
- Learners may like to create a poster for their wing corridor / notice board with book recommendations.

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Resource 1: Find someone who....

1a

Who	Name
read something today	
read something yesterday	
goes to the prison library	
likes reading books in English	
likes reading books in their own language	
reads magazines	
reads newspapers	

1b

Find someone who....	Name	What did they read?
read something today		
read something yesterday		
has read a book from the prison library		
likes reading		
has a favourite book		
reads magazines and newspapers		
likes reading to other people		



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Resource 2

The Six Book Challenge

Why read?

Lots of people enjoy reading. Reading can be fun. Reading can help improve your vocabulary and help you learn new words. It can help you learn about grammar and spelling. It can help you with skills you need at work. Reading helps you to find information, understand instructions and helps you learn language skills. Reading books can help you relax.

Helping you read with the Six Book Challenge

The Six Book Challenge is a good way to improve your reading skills. It can help you if you feel reading is difficult or feel reading books in English is difficult. It can help you if you haven't read for a long time.

To do the Six Book Challenge you can pick six things to read and then write about them in a diary to get a certificate.

You can do the Six Book Challenge in prison, in class or in the prison library. You can have a diary today.

You can read anything you like. It could be a book, a newspaper, a magazine, a poem or some reading for your workplace.

Reading can be fun!

Resource 3

How can reading help you?	What is the Six Book Challenge?
Can you read newspapers for the Six Book Challenge?	What can you read for the Six Book Challenge?
Can you read magazines for the Six Book Challenge?	Can you read books for the Six Book Challenge?
How can reading help you at work?	Can reading help you learn English?

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Resource 4a

Below are some different types of stories you can read.

1. Draw a line to match the type of book to the description? Use a dictionary to look up words. You can work in pairs.

adventure	a story often about space or time travel
romance	a story about breaking the law
humour	a true story about someone's life
biography	an exciting story
crime	a love story
science fiction (sci fi)	a book to make you laugh

2. Can you think of any other types of story or book?

.....

Look at Resource 4b

It shows pictures of quick read books.

3. Find:

- two romance stories
- two adventure stories
- two sci fi stories
- two biographies
- two crime stories

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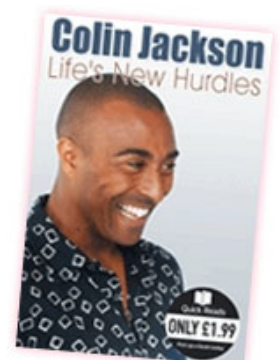
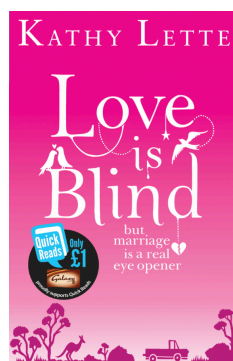
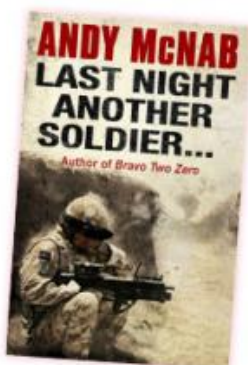
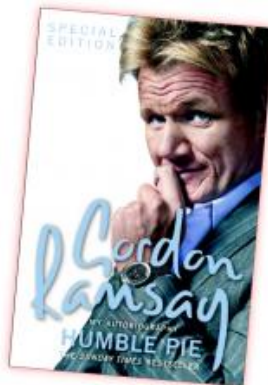
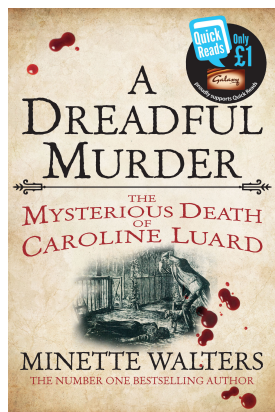
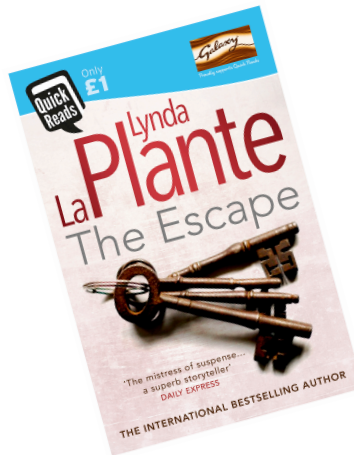
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Resource 4b



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Resource 4c – Match the descriptions to the book covers on 4b

Colin has been sent to prison. He knows that his four-year sentence means he will miss the birth of his baby. What is he to do? Will he try to escape? A story by Lynda La Plante.

Title:

Author:

It is Afghanistan in 2009. Soldiers are fighting in Helmand Province. 18 year old Davis and his four friends are soldiers. This is going to be one of the greatest adventures of their lives.

Title:

Author:

A love story where Jane is looking for a husband and decides to go to Australia to find one. Enjoy this Quick Read from Kathy Lette.

Title:

Author:

The story of the life of a famous chef, Gordon Ramsey. Gordon wanted to be a footballer and this story tells of his journey to be a TV chef.

Title:

Author:

An adventure story by Simon Kernick set in Scotland. Friends put their lives in danger when they find a mystery woman walking in the hills.

Title:

Author:

Dr Who travels in time and space and you will like this sci fi story by Jacqueline Rayner.

Title:

Author:

This is a love story about a girl who thinks she has found her perfect hero to marry. A romance by Harriet Evans.

Title:

Author:

The Krillitanes come from space to Earth. A sci fi story that is exciting and frightening.

Title:

Author:

Colin Jackson is a top athlete. This is a story about his life in sport and his work in TV.

Title:

Author: